

United Kingdom

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** January 1, 1801 **Usage:** National and Civil

The white saltire on a blue field was taken from the St. Andrew's Cross



The saltire of St. Patrick has been counter-changed with the white saltire of St. Andrew

The central red cross, fimbriated with white was adapted from the St. George's Cross

Europe



The **United Kingdom** was formed in 1707, uniting England, Scotland, and Wales. In 1801 Ireland joined, but in 1921 the south broke away.

The Union Flag is probably one of the world's best known flags, partially due to its unusual design, but more importantly, because of the importance of the British Empire in World history.

THE FIRST UNION FLAG

When King James of Scotland became King of England in 1603, both countries retained their own flags. Even today, the St. George's Cross and St. Andrew's Cross remain the flags of England and Scotland respectively. In 1606 King James considered it necessary to have a flag reflecting the new union of Scotland and England and ordered that a Union Flag, more commonly

known as the Union Jack, be flown on British ships, combining the English Cross of St. George with the Scottish Cross of St. Andrew.

A NEW UNION FLAG

In 1801, when Ireland joined the Union, the so-called Cross of St. Patrick was added to form the present flag, but was counterchanged with the Cross of St. Andrew.

A ROYAL FLAG

The Union Flag was established as a maritime flag and it remains a royal flag, not officially a national flag. In 1915, King George V gave permission for British citizens to use the flag on land.